



Netflix may buy theatres

Netflix may buy theatres to screen their original content in an attempt to make the Oscars more accessible. <https://digit.in/flixtheatres>



Dungeons & Dragons video games

Gary Gygax's unpublished work left behind after his death in 2008 may go on to become video games. <https://digit.in/ddvidgame>

support duration allows the troopers to execute longer missions in free space.

The armour plates themselves improved over the course of the movies. The Clone troopers used a plastoid-alloy composite, the Imperial stormtroopers had plastoid composite armour, while the First Order stormtroopers used composite betaplast plating. Magnatonic grip-tion panels lining the inside of the armoured plates allows them to be attached to the underlying body glove. Republic Commandos used superior Katarn armour, which provided better protection than the standard armour, but was much more expensive.

The Imperial troopers used a more threatening design, with small eye holes, and the air filtering systems separated, and fixed in a permanent frown. The First Order stormtroopers used a design where the visor was again fused together and flowed around a nose plate.

All the troopers had integrated communication systems within their helmets. The helmets invariably had an air filtration system of some sort, to process the air of various atmospheres. The Clone troopers had polarised lenses, but the imaging systems improved with time. Imperial troopers could use sophisticated visors that provided

starfighters. There were even Clone trooper hackers, or Slicers. Republic Commandos were specialised troopers with their own armour. Advanced Recon Commandos or ARCs were deployed for specialist missions, and were personally trained by Jango Fett. The ARCs were equipped with enhanced air filters, or even integrated oxygen supplies in their helmets.

The stormtroopers became even more specialised in the Imperial era. Snowtroopers were equipped to handle extremely cold environments. They had ice boots, heated pants, and enough supplies to survive for two weeks in frozen environments. The Magma troopers could operate as easily on volcanic worlds with an excess of lava.

Scout troopers had larger than usual visors that were equipped with night vision, motion detectors and target magnification. They rode on Speeder Bikes equipped with their own unique blasters. Trooper divisions could also be airborne, operate underwater, or tunnel through the ground. Death troopers, with an intimidating black armour, were used as bodyguards for VIPs.

The First Order Flametroopers, had backpacks with propellants used to torch the cover of enemies and provide cover for the stormtroopers. They could create walls of fiery infernos, through which the stormtroopers could themselves safely pass through. Flametroopers could also be used to flush out enemies from trenches, who would then be attacked by the regular stormtroopers. Their helmets had extremely narrow slits to reduce glare from the torching equipment.

The First Order also introduced riot control stormtroopers. The troopers were equipped with betaplast ballistic riot control shields, and an electric riot control baton. The batons were wielded like tonfas, and could stand up to lightsabers as well. In case the situation escalated, the riot control troopers were equipped with blasters, and were authorised to use lethal force when required.



From left to right, Clone troopers, Imperial troopers and First Order Troopers

An interesting aspect of the armour is how the knee plates evolved. Initially, they were attached to both legs and were flexible. The Imperial troopers had no knee plate on the left leg, but the right leg had a shield to protect the trooper when assuming a sniping position. The left leg had additional batteries for the suit systems. The First Order stormtroopers had flexible knee joints, which improved mobility. The First Order Flametroopers had integrated knee plates. The knee plates of stormtroopers were a weak point, and were in need of frequent replacement.

One of the most noticeable differences between stormtroopers are the changes in the helmets. The Clone troopers had a T shaped helmet, close to the original Mandalorian design.

visual overlays of the surrounding terrain. First Order stormtroopers mostly did away with any visual enhancement in their visors to keep the weight down. Instead, they were equipped with quadnoculars.

SPECIALIST TROOPERS

Although the Clone troopers were initially given all white armour, they were upgraded with colours to tell legions and specialised troopers apart. Among the earliest specialised troopers were the Shock troopers, who were deployed on Coruscant to patrol public areas and keep the citizens in line. The troopers deployed to jungle planets had camouflaged armour. Clone Pilots were another specialised branch, who were trained to fly